

welanderes — intro — “the wanderer”

there is none living now to whom I dare speak my innermost thoughts,
I travel the exile's path, for fate is relentless,
a weary heart cannot oppose inexorable fate,
the wise must know how awesome it will be
when all the wealth of the earth stands desolate,
as now, throughout the world
stand wind-blown walls, frost-covered ruined buildings.
the wine-halls crumble: monarchs lifeless lie,
deprived of pleasure, and the valiant troop
dead by the wall.

this dark life, I have often pondered,
many massacres in far off ages, and say these words:
where is the horse now, where has the hero gone?
where is the bounteous lord, where are the benches
for feasting? where are all the joys of hall?
Alas for the bright cup, the armoured warrior,
and the glory of the prince.
That time is over,
passed into night as if it had never been.